ADRIAN CIOANCA

adrian.v.cioanca@gmail.com | 0450 399 725 | Canberra, Australia | linkedin.com/in/adrian-c-58743b25a

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McKinsey & Company, APD Recruiting Team
McKinsey & Company
Sydney / Canberra, Australia

Dear McKinsey APD Recruiting Team,

I am applying to the Associate role through the Advanced Professional Degree pathway, on the strength of a PhD in retinal degeneration and several years leading postdoctoral research at the John Curtin School of Medical Research.

Why McKinsey

- Most APD candidates make the jump from the bench to a client team on faith. I have already spent time in client-facing consulting delivery at Accenture, so the part of this transition McKinsey usually has to take on trust is one I can already show evidence for.
- The APD pathway exists because McKinsey has found that people who spend years running an independent, ambiguous research problem end up well suited to running a client workstream the same way. That is the exact pattern of my recent work: I built and defended a commercial valuation for a biotech asset, then walked a compliance team through why an AI system's flagged clause actually mattered. I am not applying to test whether that pattern transfers to client work. I am applying because I have already run it against real clients, and want to do it inside McKinsey's case-team model instead of alone.

What I bring

- My PhD ran statistical modelling across 50M+ observations under peer review, rigour that earned me promotion to Level B in 1.5 years against a typical 4-5 year track, and the same discipline I now bring to scoping a client's problem before committing to an approach.
- As co-founder of a biotech spin-off I built the DCF and risk-adjusted NPV case for our lead candidate myself, raised $670K in non-dilutive funding, and delivered a $200K preclinical engagement for Merck & Co. that returned 8x its build cost.
- At Accenture I led the build of an AI retrieval system that cut a national energy retailer's regulatory-compliance review time from days to minutes, working directly with their compliance team until what we built actually matched what they needed.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how this background fits the Associate class you are building through the APD pathway. I am flexible on Sydney or Canberra and happy to provide any further materials your team needs. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Adrian Cioanca